

New Year of 2026

Vocabulary, Grammar, and Comprehension Handout Intermediate Level

THE TEXT (Corrected Version)

Note: Only grammar and spelling errors have been corrected. Corrections are shown in bold.

New Year's Eve

"Happy **New Year!**" A **wish** message from Jola got me **excited**. "I begged my parents to swing by the grocery store on our way to our hometown just now." Her **voice** gradually rose and she shared the thing that **made** her filled with enthusiasm and joy happily. "Do you believe? They agreed without hesitation!" "They said that I should get a taste of setting **off** firecrackers, so I'm selecting firecrackers with my family right now. How lucky I am!"

Jola had told me that she longed to set off **the** firecrackers after **watching** the video of my pleasant experience. I turned off the iPad after I congratulated her. Her first wish **in the** new year **had** come true, and **she asked to** immerse herself. I know I'm the only one that knows this secret.....How about me? I started thinking **about** the question with endless **anxiety** and curiosity, then continued **enjoying** myself **with** a magazine **and** a cup of hot chocolate.....

My New Achievement and Hope in 2026

"Your new goals for 2026—" A phrase in the magazine **made me slip** into a hole and **I started** struggling **with** my uncertain achievements. A new year, a new start, a new goal to achieve is indeed needed. Embarking on a new journey, countless hurdles **and** difficulties **may** appear, and I hope I could overcome them with a smile, **and** also let the challenges improve my skills. The dawn fell on me quietly. How comfortable it was! I kept writing my new hope and goals for 2026 with a confident smile while enjoying the warm sunlight. I won't limit myself **anymore**. Now, why don't you finish your goal list with me? "2026, here we go!"

THE TEXT (Improved Version)

Note: This version improves clarity and flow while preserving the original voice and meaning.

New Year's Eve

"Happy New Year!" A cheerful message from Jola caught my attention. "I just begged my parents to swing by the grocery store on our way to our hometown!" Her voice gradually rose as she shared the news that filled her with enthusiasm and joy. "Do you believe it? They agreed without hesitation!" She continued excitedly, "They said I should get a taste of setting off firecrackers, so I'm picking them out with my family right now. How lucky I am!"

Jola had told me before that she longed to set off firecrackers after watching the video of my experience. After congratulating her, I turned off the iPad. Her first wish for the new year had come true, and she wanted to fully immerse herself in the moment. I know I'm the only one who knows this little secret of hers. But what about me? I started thinking about the question with a mix of anxiety and curiosity, then went back to enjoying myself with a magazine and a cup of hot chocolate...

My New Achievement and Hope in 2026

"Your new goals for 2026—" A phrase in the magazine pulled me into a moment of deep thought, and I found myself struggling with my uncertain achievements. A new year, a new start—a new goal to achieve is indeed needed. Embarking on a new journey, countless hurdles and difficulties may appear, but I hope I can overcome them with a smile and let the challenges sharpen my skills. The dawn crept over me quietly. How peaceful it was! I kept writing my new hopes and goals for 2026 with a confident smile while basking in the warm sunlight. I won't limit myself anymore. Now, why don't you finish your goal list with me? "2026, here we go!"

PART A: VOCABULARY (12 Words)

Study the following vocabulary words from the text. Pay attention to how each word is used in context.

#	Word	Definition & Example from Text
1	swing by (phr. v.)	to make a brief, casual visit or stop. "I begged my parents to swing by the grocery store."
2	enthusiasm (n.)	intense and eager enjoyment or interest. "The thing that filled her with enthusiasm and joy."
3	hesitation (n.)	the act of pausing before doing something, often due to uncertainty. "They agreed without hesitation!"
4	long (v.)	to have a strong desire or wish for something. "She longed to set off the firecrackers."
5	immerse (v.)	to become deeply involved or absorbed in something. "She asked to immerse herself."
6	anxiety (n.)	a feeling of worry or unease about something uncertain. "I started thinking about the question with endless anxiety."
7	curiosity (n.)	a strong desire to know or learn something. "Endless anxiety and curiosity."
8	phrase (n.)	a short group of words that express a meaning. "A phrase in the magazine made me slip into a hole."
9	struggle (v.)	to try very hard to do something difficult. "I started struggling with my uncertain achievements."
10	embark (v.)	to begin a new journey, project, or course of action. "Embarking on a new journey."
11	hurdle (n.)	an obstacle or difficulty that must be overcome. "Countless hurdles and difficulties may appear."
12	overcome (v.)	to succeed in dealing with a problem or difficulty. "I hope I could overcome them with a smile."

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best word to complete each sentence.

1. She has always _____ to travel the world and experience different cultures.
 - a) struggled
 - b) longed
 - c) embarked
 - d) overcome

2. The children showed great _____ for the science experiment.
 - a) hesitation
 - b) anxiety
 - c) enthusiasm
 - d) hurdle

3. He accepted the job offer without any _____.
 - a) curiosity
 - b) hesitation
 - c) phrase
 - d) anxiety

4. If you want to learn a language, you need to _____ yourself in the culture.
 - a) embark
 - b) struggle
 - c) overcome
 - d) immerse

5. Starting a business involves many _____ along the way.
 - a) phrases
 - b) anxieties

- c) hurdles
- d) curiosities

6. Can you _____ the pharmacy on your way home?

- a) embark
- b) swing by
- c) immerse
- d) long

7. She felt a lot of _____ before her big presentation.

- a) enthusiasm
- b) curiosity
- c) hurdle
- d) anxiety

8. After months of preparation, they were ready to _____ on their adventure.

- a) struggle
- b) overcome
- c) embark
- d) immerse

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

Complete each sentence with the correct word from the box.

overcome struggle curiosity phrase enthusiasm swing by

1. Her _____ about how the universe works led her to study astronomy.
2. He tried to _____ his fear of public speaking by practicing every day.
3. The students _____ with the difficult math problems for hours.
4. I'll _____ your office after lunch to pick up the documents.
5. The coach's _____ for the sport inspired the whole team.
6. "Never give up" is a simple _____ that carries a powerful message.

PART B: GRAMMAR (4 Patterns)

Study the following grammar structures from the text.

Pattern 1: Past perfect for background events

Form: Subject + had + past participle (before another past event)

Use: To describe an action that happened before another action in the past.

Example from text: “Jola had told me that she longed to set off the firecrackers.”

More examples:

- She had already left before I arrived.
- They had never tried sushi until they visited Japan.
- He had saved enough money before he bought the car.

Pattern 2: “without + noun/gerund”

Form: Verb + without + noun / gerund (-ing form)

Use: To express the absence of something or that an action was done in the absence of something.

Example from text: “They agreed without hesitation!”

More examples:

- She left without saying goodbye.
- He passed the test without studying.
- They completed the project without any help.

Pattern 3: “while + -ing” for simultaneous actions

Form: While + -ing form, subject + verb / Subject + verb + while + -ing form

Use: To describe two actions happening at the same time (same subject).

Example from text: “I kept writing my new hopes and goals for 2026 with a confident smile while enjoying the warm sunlight.”

More examples:

- She listened to music while cooking dinner.
- While walking to school, I noticed a beautiful rainbow.
- He fell asleep while reading a book.

Pattern 4: “How + adjective + subject + verb!” (exclamatory)

Form: How + adjective + subject + verb!

Use: To express a strong feeling or reaction about something.

Example from text: “How lucky I am!” / “How comfortable it was!”

More examples:

- How beautiful this sunset is!
- How kind she was to help us!
- How quickly time passes!

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer to complete each sentence.

1. By the time the ambulance arrived, the neighbors _____ first aid.
 - a) gave
 - b) have given
 - c) had already given
 - d) giving
2. She finished the entire marathon _____ stopping once.
 - a) not
 - b) without

- c) no
- d) unless

3. He talked on the phone _____ driving to work.

- a) while
- b) during
- c) when
- d) since

4. _____ delicious this cake is!

- a) What
- b) Which
- c) How
- d) So

5. They _____ never seen a waterfall before that trip.

- a) have
- b) has
- c) had
- d) having

6. She solved the puzzle _____ asking for any clues.

- a) not
- b) without
- c) unless
- d) despite

7. _____ beautiful the garden looks in spring!

- a) What
- b) So

c) How

d) Very

8. He read a book _____ waiting for his appointment.

a) during

b) while

c) as soon as

d) until

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation

Rewrite each sentence using the pattern indicated in parentheses.

Past perfect

1. I ate lunch. Then my sister called. (By the time...)

Past perfect

2. She finished the book. Then the movie came out. (Before the movie...)

without + noun/gerund

3. He left the room. He didn't make any noise. (He left...)

without + noun/gerund

4. She passed the interview. She didn't prepare at all. (She passed...)

while + -ing

5. I was listening to a podcast. At the same time, I was jogging. (I listened...)

while + -ing

6. She was drinking coffee. At the same time, she was checking her email. (She checked...)

How + adj + S + V!

7. This movie is so exciting! (How...)

How + adj + S + V!

8. The baby is so adorable! (How...)

ANSWER KEY

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. b) longed 2. c) enthusiasm 3. b) hesitation 4. d) immerse 5. c) hurdles 6. b) swing by 7. d) anxiety 8. c) embark

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

1. curiosity 2. overcome 3. struggled 4. swing by 5. enthusiasm 6. phrase

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. c) had already given 2. b) without 3. a) while 4. c) How 5. c) had 6. b) without 7. c) How 8. b) while

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation (Sample Answers)

1. By the time my sister called, I had already eaten lunch.
2. Before the movie came out, she had finished the book.
3. He left the room without making any noise.
4. She passed the interview without preparing at all.
5. I listened to a podcast while jogging.
6. She checked her email while drinking coffee.
7. How exciting this movie is!
8. How adorable the baby is!